

```
sudo service lightdm restart # for Upstart
sudo service gdm3 restart # for Gnome 3
```

**Running shell scripts from other programs:** You can execute shell commands and scripts from other programs to automate your application tasks. In my article that appeared in the March 2016 issue of *OSFY*, I have shown how to add shell commands/scripts to the Nautilus/Caja file manager as the context menu options. Many other programs provide shell support. In Pluma/Gedit (the default text editor), I have an 'external tool command' to convert Markdown files to formatted HTML.

```
perl ~/MyScripts/markdown.pl --html4tags \
"$GEDIT_CURRENT_DOCUMENT_NAME" > \
"${GEDIT_CURRENT_DOCUMENT_NAME%.}.html"
```

You will have to look up the help documentation of the application to find out how to run shell commands.

I use isolated Firefox profiles to load Web pages with Adobe Flash or run the browser behind a US-based proxy IP. These profiles can be quickly loaded from other programs or from a launcher (a short cut) using special command line options.

```
# Create a new profile and specify its settings
firefox -ProfileManager
```

```
#Load a created a named profile
firefox -p ProxyIpProfile
firefox -p AdobeFlashProfile
```

You will be surprised how many popular GUI programs

have an elaborate command line interface. *cvlc* is the command line version of the media player VLC. I use it to play audio files from the terminal.

While there are a lot of GUI programs for GNU/Linux, there are several times more command line utilities written for it and its predecessor, UNIX. The Linux userland abounds with command-line solutions for situations where the GUI option is deficient or does not exist. For example, there is a wonderful program called *alsamixer*, which provides a command line version of 'Sound Preferences'. I was able to configure my near-vintage Pinnacle TV tuner using this program. If 'Network Manager' failed to recognise your wireless modem, then *wvdial* will still be able to configure and use it. *Espeak* can convert text arguments to voiced audio, which can then be captured as wave files. I use the wave files to provide audio notifications from my bash scripts and to annotate my YouTube videos.

Well... one can go on forever like this. The terminal can become your best friend and saviour. All that you need to do is a bit of exploring and some inevitable trial-and-error to get the best out of your system. 

## References

- [1] [http://www.linuxcommand.org/learning\\_the\\_shell.php](http://www.linuxcommand.org/learning_the_shell.php) 'Learning the shell'
- [2] <http://tldp.org/HOWTO/Bash-Prompt-HOWTO/index.html> 'BASH Programming - Introduction HOW-TO'
- [3] <http://www.ibm.com/developerworks/linux/library/l-tip-prompt/> 'Tip: Prompt magic'

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